neither inevitable nor anticipated, Lorde's pre-1989 Berlin poems look for ways to undermine or connect across the lines of division. She would primarily consider the existence of the Berlin Wall amid other divisions. Alternately, her post-1989 poems and writing showcase Lorde's sense of wariness about how the *Wende* affected life in Berlin, especially for Afro-Germans and people of color, specifically employing the name "Berlin Wall" to make her critical insights more clear.

These interventions into the *Wende* period mark Lorde's poems in *The Marvelous Arithmetics of Distance*. Though her Berlin poems in *Our Dead Behind Us* also dealt with the division of the Wall, these later poems reflect the historical challenges of reunification after 1989. Several poems in *The Marvelous Arithmetics of Distance* explicitly deal with the Berlin Wall and the dynamics of Berlin's transformed border.[33] Despite the altered imperatives of the work, in each case Lorde's rendering of Berlin deals with its multiple intersections of division—and the city as a source of public and private reflection.

For example, the poem "East Berlin" opens with the declarative statement, "It feels dangerous now / to be Black in Berlin."[34] The subject of this poem is disembodied and impersonal. Yet her use of "it" makes her statement declarative and factual. Lorde's sense of the new geography of reunification is based on well-known urban landmarks but eschewed, as her narrator zigzags back and forth between the former West and East and through time, channeling a cosmopolitanism that incubates violent conditions ("sad suicides that never got reported / Neukölln Kreuzberg the neon Zoo / a new siege along Unter den Linden"). Her poetic mapping of "East Berlin" is as a geopolitical anachronism, as the notion of an "East Berlin" is defunct in the reunified Germany. Lorde's use of extra spatial pausing here separates her calling out of areas in former West Berlin (Neukölln, Kreuzberg, Zoologischer Garten) to suggest dislocation amid the post-Wall borderlines, with the separation furthered by the sequential references to East Berlin's Unter den Linden and Alexanderplatz. The concrete materiality and hard edges of the Wall are transferred to the sidewalk in a scene of violence plaguing reunified Berlin.

Though the Wall is already partially dismantled at the point of her writing, Lorde repurposes the changes afoot around it as signs of the new dangers for people of color in Germany. She remains wary of the attempts to move forward from the past without reconciliation and proper attention for